

dirty, there are many things you can do—for example, changing the scanning options, changing the advanced options, and so on. The help file should come in handy in this case.

Then there are the scan modes: “smart system scan,” “full system scan,” “custom scanning options,” and “scan volume for ADS,” all of which—except for the last—are self-explanatory. It turns out that ADS is not ‘ads,’ but stands for Alternate Data Streams. More information on this can be found at http://wiki.castlecops.com/Ad-Aware_FAQ#Alternate_Data_Streams/



If you want to play around, you can get to screens such as this one!

So apart from ADS, what does Ad-Aware scan for? Basically, spyware. From Lavasoft’s Web site: “Ad-Aware is designed to provide advanced protection from known Data-mining, aggressive advertising, Parasites, Scumware, selected traditional Trojans, Diallers, Malware, Browser hijackers, and tracking components.”

Apart from scanning for ADS, everything else is straightforward enough. That’s what makes Ad-Aware so popular—apart from, of course, the fact that it’s free for non-commercial use.

7.3.2 Spybot - Search & Destroy (SS&D)

SS&D is reputed to be one of the best spyware scanners out there. Also, it’s been said that SS&D complements Ad-Aware well. However, there might be a couple of hiccups with the interface before you get to being able to perform a full system scan! More about these later...